Lead Broker Blueprint by Lorenzo Marietti

Cross-Module Reference

Vertical Quick-Start Cards

One action-focused page per vertical — what to do in your first week if you've picked HVAC, Personal Injury, Medicare, or Mortgage. Everything from across the Blueprint, consolidated.

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How to use these cards

After you've used the Module 2 Niche Evaluation Worksheet to land on a vertical, pull the matching card below and execute it. Each card cross-references the deliverables you'll need across the Blueprint — so instead of re-reading every module, you have a single per-vertical action plan.

Each card answers six questions: who buys, what they pay, what the lead profile looks like, which channels work, compliance gotchas specific to the vertical, and a 30-day starter action plan.

Vertical Card 1 — HVAC Replacement

Who buys

- Independent local contractors (1-5 trucks). Owner-operated. Volume per buyer: 5-15 leads/mo.
- Regional contractor chains (10-50 locations). Marketing director makes the buying decision. Volume per buyer: 50-300 leads/mo.
- PE-rollup home services companies (Wrench Group, ARS, others). Corporate marketing. Volume per buyer: 100-1,000 leads/mo at scale.
- Manufacturer dealer networks (Carrier Authorized, Lennox Premier). Brand-affiliated buyers with co-op marketing budgets.

What buyers pay

- Form leads: $35-$75 each, shared (multi-buyer).
- Form leads, exclusive: $75-$150 each.
- Phone-qualified estimate appointments: $150-$350 each.
- Live warm transfers (consumer on the line, contractor accepts): $200-$400 each.

Lead profile that converts

- Confirmed homeowner (not renter, not landlord-for-tenant).
- Property in the contractor's service area (typically a defined list of ZIPs).
- Current system age 8+ years OR has been told a replacement is needed.
- Replacement timeline: 0-90 days. (Longer timelines convert to estimates but rarely to installations within the contractor's billing window.)
- Not currently engaged with another contractor on this specific project.

Channels that work

- Google Search (paid). Primary channel; expect 50-70% of total lead volume.
- NextDoor (paid + organic). Hyperlocal, homeowner-dense, high-trust. See Modern Channels deliverable 4.1.
- Direct mail to new-mover lists. See Modern Channels 3.3 for life-event triggers.
- Meta paid (declining but still viable for 35-65 demographic). Use lookalike audiences from past converters.
- Pay-per-call on niche home-services podcasts (Modern Channels 4.2).

Compliance gotchas

- TCPA: ZIP-targeting cell phone numbers requires PEWC consent. Use TrustedForm for proof.
- State licensing: confirm your contractor buyer holds the required state HVAC license. Several states (FL, CA, GA, NC, VA) require contractor licenses; selling leads to unlicensed buyers exposes both sides.
- Estimate-not-quote: the lead is for an in-home estimate, NOT a binding quote. Make this clear to consumers to avoid "you said it would cost X" disputes downstream.

30-day starter action plan

1. Pick 2-3 metros in your target geography. Confirm 5+ contractor candidates per metro before launching ads.
2. Set up TrustedForm + Google Ads + a single landing page per metro per service ("AC Replacement", "Furnace Replacement", "Full System").
3. Begin outreach to 30-40 HVAC contractors in your target metros via the Module 4 sequence.
4. Run ads at $30-$50/day per metro. Phone-qualify every lead within 5 minutes of submission using the Module 5 Intake Script Templates + Cold-to-Warm Playbook scripts.
5. Sign first pilot agreement within 21 days. Deliver at quality before scaling spend.

Vertical Card 2 — Personal Injury

Who buys

- Solo and small-firm PI attorneys (1-10 attorneys). Managing partner decides. Volume: 5-25 leads/mo.
- Mid-size PI firms (10-50 attorneys). Intake director or marketing director decides. Volume: 50-300 leads/mo.
- National PI brands (Morgan & Morgan, JG Wentworth). VP of marketing + vendor-management team. Volume: high but bar to enter is highest.
- Mass-tort lead aggregators (case-acquisition firms for specific torts). Vertical-specific; spike with case events.

What buyers pay

- Form leads, shared: $25-$75.
- Form leads, exclusive: $80-$200.
- Phone-qualified intakes: $150-$500.
- Live transfer to firm intake or attorney: $250-$800 (especially high-value torts like 18-wheeler, brain injury, wrongful death).

Lead profile that converts

- Accident within the relevant state's statute of limitations (typically 1-3 years; varies by state and tort type — see Module 3 Regulatory Citation Reference).
- Injury occurred AND consumer received or is receiving medical treatment.
- Not already represented by another attorney for the same matter.
- Liability is favorable: clear at-fault other party, or in modified-comparative-negligence state where partial fault doesn't bar recovery.

Channels that work

- Google Search (paid). Primary. Expect high CPCs ($30-$80) in major metros.
- YouTube paid (skippable in-stream + bumper ads). Trust-building plays well for PI.
- Podcast advertising (Modern Channels 4.2). Especially host-read on local-news and true-crime podcasts.
- AI Search Optimization (Modern Channels 1.1). PI consumers increasingly ask ChatGPT/Perplexity which firm to call.

- Quiz-funnel landing pages (Modern Channels 6.1). "What's your case worth?" funnels convert dramatically better than static forms.

Compliance gotchas

- State bar advertising rules. Every state's bar has specific rules on attorney advertising — disclaimers, no "specialist" claims unless certified, geographic accuracy. Your buyer's compliance team must review your landing pages and ad creative.
- Recording disclosure: most PI calls are recorded; ensure proper notice in two-party-consent states.
- UPL risk: don't give legal advice in your scripts. Stick to qualifying-for-the-attorney language. "Have you spoken to a lawyer about this?" is fine; "You have a case worth $X" is unauthorized practice of law.
- FTC: claims about outcomes ("average settlement is $X") require substantiation and qualification.

30-day starter action plan

6. Pick a state. PI is state-specific because liability rules vary. Start with one state where you can comply confidently.
7. Pick a sub-vertical: auto accident is volume-rich and competitive; slip-and-fall, dog bite, premises liability are smaller but less crowded.
8. Build the landing page with state-bar-compliant disclaimers reviewed by your buyer's counsel before launch.
9. Outreach to 20-30 PI firms via Module 4 sequence. Reference your state-specific compliance posture.
10. Launch ads at conservative budget ($50-$100/day). PI CPCs are high; expect higher cost per qualified lead than other verticals. Validate quality before scaling.

Vertical Card 3 — Medicare

Who buys

- FMOs (Field Marketing Organizations): Integrity Marketing, AmeriLife, Senior Market Sales, TogetherHealth, Senior Healthcare Direct. Marketing acquisition leads decide.
- Direct-to-consumer brokerages: eHealth, GoHealth, SelectQuote. Vendor-management or paid-media director decides.
- Independent multi-carrier agencies. Owner-operator decides. Volume: 10-50 leads/mo.
- Captive agent networks (UHC, Humana captive agents). Regional sales director decides.

What buyers pay

- Form leads, shared: $15-$40.
- Form leads, exclusive: $35-$80.
- Phone-qualified leads: $40-$120.
- Live transfers (licensed agent on line, ready for SOA): $80-$300.
- AEP (Annual Enrollment Period, Oct 15 - Dec 7) pricing typically 30-100% higher than non-AEP.

Lead profile that converts

- Age 65+ OR qualifying for Medicare (disability, ESRD).
- Currently enrolled in Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage, Medicare Supplement, or none — depending on buyer's intent.
- Within an applicable election period (AEP, IEP, SEP, OEP — see Module 3 for the calendar).
- Specific zip code matches buyer's licensed-state coverage area.
- Has prescription drug list available (for Part D conversations).

Channels that work

- Google Search (paid). Heavy AEP seasonality; ramps up August, peaks October-November.
- Direct mail to turning-65 lists (Modern Channels 3.3). Very effective for IEP.
- Linear TV and CTV (Modern Channels 4.3). Senior demographic still consumes broadcast heavily.
- Podcast advertising on senior-focused shows.
- AI Search Optimization (1.1) — emerging; seniors are slower adopters but the market is growing.
- AVOID: most TikTok / Reels; not the right demographic at scale.

Compliance gotchas

- CMS rules are extensive. SOA (Scope of Appointment) must be completed before discussing any plan. PTC (Permission to Contact) must be on file before outbound calls about MA/Part D.
- Recording compliance: most Medicare sales calls are recorded and stored for 10 years per CMS. Verify your buyer's recording posture before sending leads.
- Buyer must be licensed in the consumer's state. Always confirm before transfer.
- "Medicare" trademark: don't imply official affiliation with Medicare or government. Use approved language in ad creative.
- Recent CMS final rules (2024-2025) tightened lead-generation rules: third-party marketing organizations (TPMO) need clear disclosure, certain consent flows require specific language. Read the Module 3 deliverable for current state.

30-day starter action plan

11. Pick 3-5 states with high Medicare-eligible populations: FL, AZ, CA, PA, OH are large markets.
12. Pick your sub-vertical: Medicare Advantage (high volume), Medicare Supplement (smaller, less regulated), Part D (transactional). MA + Supp combined is the most common starting point.
13. Build CMS-compliant landing pages. Have buyer's compliance team review before launch.
14. Outreach to 30-40 FMOs and independent agencies via Module 4 sequence.
15. Plan campaign timing around the calendar: ramp ad spend August-November during AEP, hold during quiet months, target SEP-eligible consumers (turning 65, moving, losing other coverage) year-round.

Vertical Card 4 — Mortgage

Who buys

- Independent mortgage brokers. Owner or lead loan officer decides. Volume: 5-50 leads/mo per buyer.
- Mid-size mortgage banks (community lenders). Marketing director decides.
- Retail divisions of large lenders: Rocket Mortgage, UWM, Pennymac retail. Paid-media manager or vendor-management decides.
- Aggregators: LendingTree, Bankrate, Zillow Mortgage. Vendor onboarding teams decide.

What buyers pay

- Form leads, shared: $15-$50.
- Form leads, exclusive (refinance or purchase intent): $35-$120.
- Phone-qualified leads with credit pull authorization: $80-$250.
- Live transfer to LO (Loan Officer) on the line: $150-$500.
- Pricing varies massively by interest-rate environment. High-rate / refinance-cold environment depresses prices 30-50%.

Lead profile that converts

- For purchase: timeline 0-6 months, pre-approval status known, credit range disclosed, property identified or actively searching.
- For refinance: current rate is 50+ basis points above current market, credit qualifying, equity position adequate.
- Income disclosed (range).
- Geographic concentration matters — some lenders are licensed only in specific states.

Channels that work

- Google Search (paid). Primary, especially for purchase. High CPCs.
- Meta paid. Especially Lookalikes from past closed-loan customers.
- Calculator/tool funnels (Modern Channels 6.2). Mortgage calculators are the canonical example of utility-driven lead gen.
- SMS/RCS opt-in funnels (Modern Channels 2.1-2.3). Mortgage shoppers respond well to text-based engagement.
- Intent-data overlays (Modern Channels 3.2). Real-estate-listing-view signals + neighborhood-search activity.

- Newsletter sponsorships in finance newsletters (Modern Channels 5.3).

Compliance gotchas

- RESPA: prohibits steering, kickbacks, and undisclosed referral fees. Lead-buy relationships must be properly structured.
- ECOA: equal credit opportunity. Don't ask demographic questions that could be used for discriminatory practices.
- TILA / Reg Z advertising rules: APR disclosure required when you advertise specific rates.
- State licensing: most states require mortgage broker / lender licenses. Confirm your buyer is licensed in the consumer's state. Some states (NY, CA, NJ) have specific TPM (third-party marketing) disclosure requirements.
- FCRA: any solicitation that uses credit-related triggers (refinance offers triggered by credit score) must comply with FCRA Section 604(c) prescreen rules.

30-day starter action plan

16. Pick state(s) where you can build solid buyer relationships — concentrate, don't spread.
17. Pick sub-vertical: purchase, refinance, HELOC, or VA-loan-specific. Purchase is more rate-environment-resilient than refinance.
18. Build either a calculator-funnel or a quiz-funnel landing page. Mortgage consumers respond especially well to interactive tools.
19. Outreach to 30-40 brokers and lenders via Module 4 sequence.
20. Launch ads at conservative budget. Monitor lead quality closely — mortgage buyers are especially intolerant of bad-credit or out-of-spec leads.

Closing

These four cards cover the verticals where the largest portion of lead-broker revenue currently flows. If you've picked a different vertical (e.g., solar, home security, debt relief, auto insurance, education), the structure of this card applies — substitute the specific buyer types, lead profiles, channels, and compliance gotchas for your chosen vertical.

The Niche Evaluation Worksheet (Module 2 deliverable) is the tool that helps you build the equivalent card for any other vertical. Use the same six headings; do the research; produce the same end document.

— Lorenzo